

/automation

Automation service: /automation [list] | runs | run | help

Overview

/automation is the TUI surface for the automation service (spec openhands T-016; FR-013, FR-014, FR-018, FR-033). An **automation** is a named, schedulable or webhook-triggered agent run with a durable definition and run history.

- **Webhook-triggered** automations fire from an inbound HTTP POST /auto/<id> (FR-013). The request body is supplied to the run as prompt context.
- **Schedule-triggered** automations fire when the scheduler reaches their due time, using the same schedule grammar as /cron (every 2m, at <ts>, ...) (FR-014).
- Every run is **confined to the automation's configured execution backend** (FR-033), and every terminal run is recorded in durable run history with the automation id, trigger, start/end times, outcome, backend, and output reference (FR-018).

Definitions

Automations are declared under the automation block in .ragent/ragent.json:

```
{
  "automation": {
    "enabled": true,           // master switch; absence leaves the service inert
    "run_history_cap": 500,    // run records retained per automation
    "scheduler_tick_secs": 30, // scheduler tick interval
    "automations": [
      {
        "id": "on-issue",      // unique; also the webhook URL segment
        "agent": "general",     // agent to run (defaults to defaultAgent)
        "prompt": "Triage {{payload}}", // {{payload}} is the trigger payload
        "trigger": { "kind": "webhook" },
        "backend": "local",     // execution backend the run is confined to
        "dispatch": [          // optional third-party notifications
          { "kind": "slack", "url": "https://hooks.slack.com/...", "token_env": "SLACK_BOT_TOKEN" }
        ]
      },
      {
        "id": "nightly",
        "trigger": { "kind": "schedule", "schedule": "every 2m" },
        "backend": "local"
      }
    ]
  }
}
```

The service is inert unless automation.enabled is explicitly true on a present automation block, so a project that never opted in starts no scheduler and accepts no webhook.

Dispatch targets name the environment variable their credential is read from (token_env); the value is

never stored in the config (FR-035). Supported kinds are `slack`, `github`, `linear`, `notion`, and `webhook` (a generic JSON POST). A target with no `url` is inert.

Subcommands

Subcommand	Description
<code>/automation</code>	List configured automations with trigger, schedule, backend, and next-due time
<code>/automation list</code>	Alias of <code>/automation</code>
<code>/automation runs <id></code>	Show an automation's durable run history
<code>/automation run <id></code>	Enqueue a manual run now
<code>/automation help</code>	Show the usage block

HTTP surface

Method	Path	Auth	Purpose
POST	<code>/auto/<id></code>	public	Webhook ingress; enqueues a run with the body as context (FR-013)
GET	<code>/automation</code>	bearer	List configured automations and next-due times
GET	<code>/automation/runs/<id></code>	bearer	List an automation's run history
POST	<code>/automation/<id>/run</code>	bearer	Enqueue a manual run

CLI parity

```
ragent automation list
ragent automation runs <id>
ragent automation run <id>
ragent automation help
```

Examples

```
# Webhook ingress (from an external system)
curl -s -X POST http://127.0.0.1:3000/auto/on-issue \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"issue":"42","title":"fix login"}'
```

```
# Inspect from the TUI
/automation
/automation runs on-issue
/automation run nightly
```